

-WELCOME-

Conference II.

Working Together to Help Our Seniors



Lunenburg Board of Assessor's

Live Active Live Well Council On Aging

Lunenburg Adult Activity Center

TAX RELIEF PROGRAMS

Circuit Breaker Tax Credit

The Circuit Breaker Tax Credit enables residents aged 65 and older who meet eligibility guidelines to claim a refundable credit on your Massachusetts personal income tax return. The Circuit Breaker tax credit is based on the actual real estate taxes or rent paid on the Massachusetts residential property you own or rent and occupy as your principal residence.

If the credit you are owed exceeds the amount of the total tax payable for the year, you will be refunded the additional amount of the credit without interest.

If you are a homeowner, your Massachusetts property tax payments, together with half of your water and sewer expenses, must exceed 10% of your total Massachusetts income for the tax year. If you are a renter, 25% of your annual Massachusetts rent must exceed 10% of your total Massachusetts income for the tax year.

There are maximums stated for the assessed value of the residence as well as maximum credit amounts subject to change each year.

SENIOR TAX WORKOFF PROGRAM

The Town of Lunenburg offers income eligible senior citizens age 60+ an opportunity to receive up to \$1500 off their property tax bill. Between January 1 and November 1, a person will receive \$15.00 per hour up to 100 hours, to receive the \$1500 abatement. Any hours worked beyond that will be considered volunteer hours. Applications and more information can be found at the Lunenburg Adult Activity Center and Town Hall.

TAX DEFERRALS AND EXEMPTIONS

Residents age 60+ and older, veterans and residents with disabilities may be eligible for additional exemptions. For more information contact the Assessor's office at 978-582-4145.

LUNENBURG ADULT ACTIVITY CENTER

Live Active | Live Well

COUNCIL ON AGING

The mission of the Lunenburg Council on Aging is to advocate for improved quality of life for all seniors through supportive services, programs, and education. This brochure provides an overview of programs available to seniors in our community to increase access to food, fuel, and financial assistance.

FOOD AND NUTRITION PROGRAMS

SNAP (Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program)

SNAP can help you expand your healthy food budget and explore opportunities to support your wellbeing, education, and employment.

HOME MODIFICATION LOAN PROGRAM

A state loan program that could help you or a loved one live more independently at home.

cedac.org/find-out-if-you-qualify

MEALS ON WHEELS

Meals on Wheels are delivered by Lunenburg CDA volunteers to seniors who are homebound or otherwise unable to prepare their own meals. Eligibility is determined by Making Opportunity Count (MOC). For more information reach out to the Lunenburg Adult Activity Center at 978-582-4166 or MOC at 978-345-8501 x5.

HEATING ASSISTANCE

THE LOW INCOME HOME ENERGY ASSISTANCE PROGRAM (LIEAP)

Known commonly as Fuel Assistance, LIEAP provides eligible households with assistance.

Concerned about Medicare Costs? There may be help!

Medicare premiums, deductibles and co-payments can add up. Luckily, there are several programs that can help a beneficiary with Medicare cost-sharing. Below is a list of these programs, their eligibility requirements, information about applying, and the benefits they provide. If you have any questions regarding these programs, you may contact a SHINE Counselor at MassHealth at (1-800-243-4636).

	Gross Monthly Income Limit	Asset Limit	Application	Benefits
MassHealth (65+ years old)	\$1,259 (individual) \$1,704 (couple) ¹	\$2,000 (individual) ² \$3,000 (couple) ²	MassHealth SACA-2 form 1-800-841-2900	Supplemental health and drug coverage Automatic enrollment in Extra Help
Medicare Savings Program (QMB)	\$2,385 (individual) \$3,237 (couple)	None	MassHealth SACA-2 form or MIBSI application 1-800-841-2900	Pays Medicare Part A & B premiums Pays Medicare Part A & B deductibles & copays Automatic enrollment in Extra Help
Medicare Savings Program (SLMB/QI-1)	\$2,824 (individual) \$3,833 (couple)	None	MIBSI application 1-800-841-2900	Pays Medicare Part B premium Automatic enrollment in Extra Help
Extra Help	\$1,883 (individual) \$2,555 (couple)	\$17,220 (individual) ³ \$34,360 (couple) ³	Application for Extra Help 1-800-772-1213	Reduces Part D premium (eliminates Part D deductible) Lowest Part D copays to \$4.50/\$11.20 (if 55+ category)
Prescription Advantage (65+ years old)	\$6,275 (individual) \$8,511 (couple)	NONE	Application 1-800-243-4636	Supplemental prescription coverage that reduces copays once the total retail costs of covered prescription drugs reaches \$5,080 (\$4,371 if 55+ category)
Prescription Advantage (Under 65 years old)	\$2,359 (individual) \$3,202 (couple)	NONE	Application 1-800-243-4636	Supplemental prescription coverage that pays prescription copays once out-of-pocket drug costs reach \$5,080
Health Safety Net	Full: \$1,883 (individual) \$2,555 (couple) Partial: \$3,765 (individual) \$5,110 (couple)	NONE	MassHealth SACA-2 form (65+ years old) 1-800-841-2900	Pays for some services received at a hospital or Community Health Center (CHC) Rx & dental available at some CHCs

¹ If over the income limit, may qualify by meeting a deductible
² Primary residence and one vehicle are not counted
³ Primary residence, vehicle, and life insurance are not counted

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SAVE ENERGY SAVE MONEY

The average value is \$5500. The cost limit per home is \$10,000 for energy improvements.

HEATING SYSTEM REPAIR AND REPLACEMENT

MOC's Heating System Repair and Replacement Program (HEARTWAP) provides heating system repairs and replacements for income eligible homeowners. The program is operational year-round. During the winter months, the program focuses on aiding low-income clients who are in their primary heating system. The program also provides services for all types of heating systems, including gas, oil, and electric. The program also provides services for all types of heating systems, including gas, oil, and electric. The program also provides services for all types of heating systems, including gas, oil, and electric.

WEATHERIZATION

When you are approved for Fuel Assistance you are automatically eligible for a discount on your monthly utility or other electricity provider bill. For detailed information on criteria used for eligibility, please contact MOC at 978-345-4520 or go to www.mocinc.org.

Lunenburg's Outreach Program: Builds & Binds A Community



“How Can We Help You?” Seniors Conference II

Sponsored by the Lunenburg Board Of Assessors

Date Feb 3 2025 1- 3PM

Lunenburg Adult Activity Center

To Assure we have enough seats, Please call 978-582-4166 and share your intent to attend.

Join Zoom Meeting : <https://us02web.zoom.us/j/7927370353?omn=87954586568> ID# 792 737 0353

Purpose: Provide the Citizens Of Lunenburg with New and Additional Beneficial Information; Specific to their Property Related Interests and Personal Well Being.

Conference Agenda:

- I. Lunenburg's Changing Senior Imperative... COA - Deb Lincoln (Chairman)
... BOA - John Rabbitt
- II. Updates from Beacon Hill: State Representative - Margaret Scarsdale
- III. Lunenburg Senior Housing Update: ... Select Bd. Vice Chairman – Michael-Ray Jeffreys
- IV. Property Tax Exemptions & Changes ... Principal Assessor- Lynda McQuade
- V. Game Changers:
 - A. Senior Circuit Breaker & 41A Deferral Clause ... BOA - John Rabbitt
 - B. Lunenburg Senior Tax Relief Bill... Select Bd. Authors - Tom Alonzo & Lou Franco
- VI. Senior Tax Work Off Program & Volunteers ... Select Board Chairman – Caesar Nuzzolo
- VII. Questions and Answers

Lunenburg's Changing Senior Imperative...

- Deb Lincoln (COA)
- John Rabbitt (BOA)

- + Lunenburg Population Demographics
- + Home Sales Prices
- + Home Mortgage & Interest Rates
- + Your Future Home Value and Your Anticipated Taxes

Fact:

More than 9 million Americans likely qualify for property tax relief, but only 8% apply for it.
(Your AARP: March 2023)

Fact:

+ 8.3% of All Lunenburg Residents Live below the Poverty Line. (= @ 974 Residents Total)

+ Lunenburg has a Senior Population (65+) of @2,010. A total of Lunenburg 261 Seniors (or 13%) live Below the Poverty Line.
(American Community Survey : Fed Census 2022)

2024 MassHealth Income Standards and Federal Poverty Guidelines

Effective March 1, 2024

Family Size	MassHealth Income Standards		100% Federal Poverty Level	
	Monthly	Yearly	Monthly	Yearly
1	\$522	\$6,264	\$1,255	\$15,060
2	\$650	\$7,800	\$1,704	\$20,448

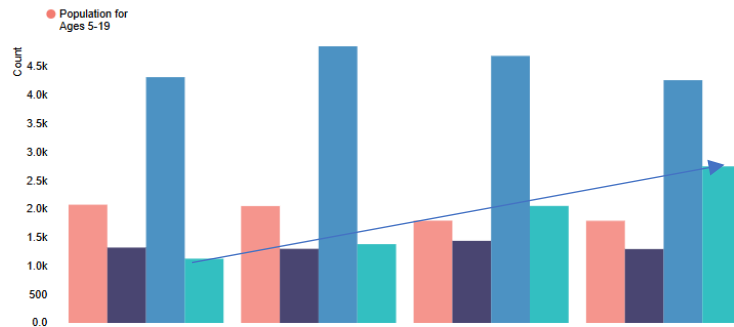
<https://www.mass.gov/doc/2024-masshealth-income-standards-and-federal-poverty-guidelines-0/download>

Lunenburg Population Demographics

In 2010, working-age adults between 20 and 65 made up 62 percent of the population and seniors over 65 made up 14 percent.

With the aging of the Baby Boomers, Massachusetts is growing older. The senior population is expected to increase by 100 percent over the next two decades, an increase mirrored in almost every city and town.

In Lunenburg, the aging of the Baby Boomers will cause the senior population to increase by 1,400 people, or 100 percent, through 2030, as seen in Figure 1. The total population is projected to increase by 1,000, or 10 percent, over the same period.



The Metropolitan Area Planning Council (MAPC), and University of Mass Donahue Institute

https://www.neilsberg.com/research/datasets		2024
Age Group	Population	% of Total Population
Under 5 years	524	4.47%
5 to 9 years	806	6.87%
10 to 14 years	794	6.77%
15 to 19 years	801	6.83%
Total School Age	2401	20.47%
20 to 24 years	481	4.10%
25 to 29 years	376	3.20%
30 to 34 years	832	7.09%
35 to 39 years	804	6.85%
40 to 44 years	792	6.75%
45 to 49 years	872	7.43%
50 to 54 years	726	6.19%
55 to 59 years	906	7.72%
Total Adults	5789	49.33%
60 to 64 years	1,011	8.62%
65 to 69 years	575	4.90%
70 to 74 years	671	5.72%
75 to 79 years	371	3.16%
80 to 84 years	267	2.28%
85 years and over	126	1.07%
Total Seniors	3,021	25.75%
Total Population	11,735	

57.95% Total Adults

Seniors 65+ = 2,010
17.3 %

3,021 are
Voting Tax
Paying
Seniors (60+)

The Lunenburg Adult Activity Center supports approximately 3000 active Senior Members.

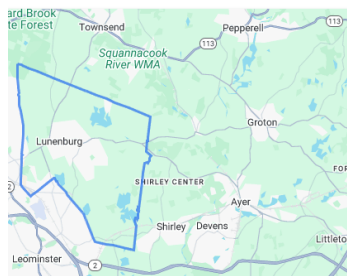
What does this mean?

The direction and pace at which home prices are changing are indicators of the strength of the housing market and whether homes are becoming more or less affordable. The median price of a home in the United States is currently \$630,100.

Location	Data Nov 2024	Growth % YoY	
● Massachusetts	\$630,100	+5.8%	
● 01462, MA	\$529,000	+8.6%	×

Redfin : Last Year's Lunenburg Home Sale's Price Increased @ 8.6% = 529K or @ \$ 45.5 K from prior year.

Zillow



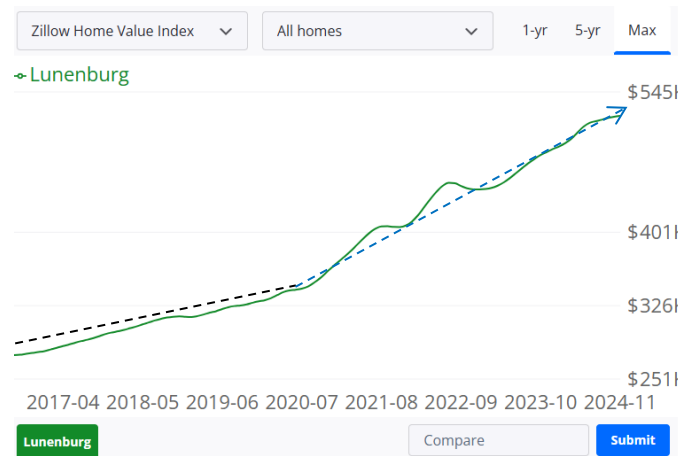
Lunenburg Key Takeaways

Typical Home Values: \$520,647

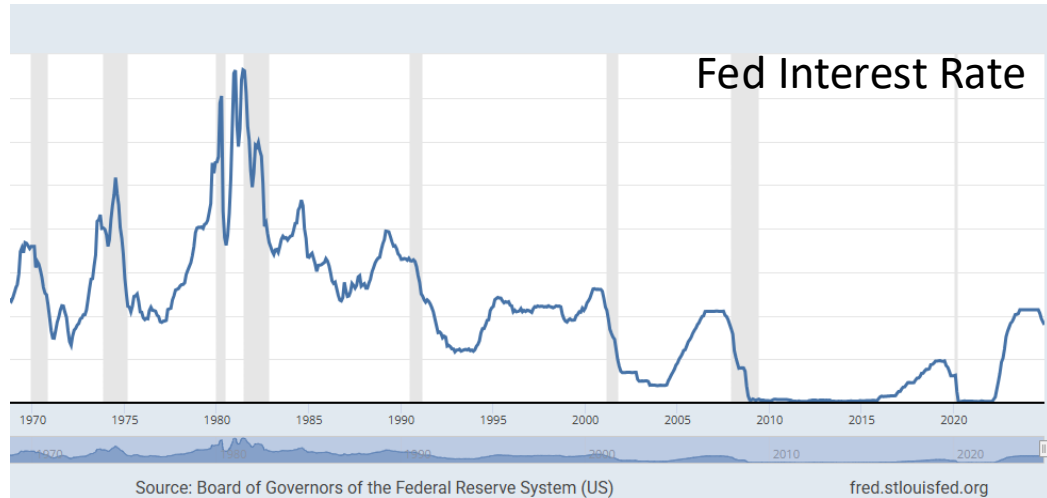
1-year Value Change: +7.6%

(Data through November 30, 2024)

<https://www.zillow.com/home-values/395684/lunenburg-ma/>



Zillow: Last Years Lunenburg Home Sale's Prices Increased @ 7.6% to \$520,647 or @ \$ 39.5 K. from prior year.



Current Home Mortgage Rates: (Dec 2024)

30 Year Fixed Rate = 7.2%

15 Year Fixed = 6.4%

5 Year Adjustable = 7.1%

Reverse Mortgage Rates: Fixed Rate 7.4 -7.9%

Mass 41A : Lunenburg Deferral Interest Rate = 4%

I, Kathryn M. Herrick, Town Clerk, hereby certify that at the Annual Town Meeting of the inhabitants of the Town of Lunenburg held May 6, 2006 the following action was taken:

ARTICLE 32. VOTED UNANIMOUSLY to reduce from 8% to 4% the rate of interest that accrues on property taxes deferred by eligible seniors under MGL Chapter 59, §5, Clause 41, as amended by chapter 136 section 1 of the Acts of 2005, with such reduced rate to apply to taxes assessed for any fiscal year beginning on or after July 1, 2006. (Board of Selectmen & Finance Committee recommend Approval)



How has the BOA Responded?

Town now has consistent practices with surrounding communities

+ Exemption Improvements for our Citizens.

- 1. Lowered Age Eligibility
- 2. Increased Asset Eligibility
- 3. Increased Resident Reimbursements
- 4. Provided for Automatic Cost of Living Adjustments

+ The assessment to sales ratio for class 1 is 94%, 3 family 95%, and apt buildings are 96%. (With Adjusted Land values up 6%)

+ 5 Year Revaluation Completed & DOR “Compliance” is on track

+ Increased our community “Outreach & Involvement”

In the spirit of “Openness”; We have many more Detailed & Accessible Evening Meetings including PAC & Zoom, Timely and Detailed Minutes, Working with our Senior population with help from LAAC Employees (Senior Center) & and the Council on Aging.

+ Restructured the BOA WEB Site & Built for the Future!!!

Assessed Values By Location	2024 Tax Rate Information	Resources	Abatements, Exemptions & Deferrals	Assessor's Toolbox
2024	Historic Tax Rates	Your Board of Assessors	Tax Abatements	Massachusetts Municipal Property Taxes
2023	2024 Five Year Revaluation	Town Charter: Assessors	Property Exemptions	Assessor Training Modules
2022	Find Your House & Assessor Residential Questionnaire	Vision and Mission Statement	Deferrals	Assessors' Site Inspection & Data Collection Handbook
Citizen Information	Property Cards & CAMA Codes	Mass. Conflict of Interest Summary	State Property Tax Resources	Assessor Organizational Performance Metrics
Recent News	How to Read Your Property Card	Organizations Codes of Ethics	Appeals: Commonwealth of MA Appellate Tax Board	Board of Assessor's Policies & Procedures Manual
2024 How Can We Help Conference	Property Search		DOR Sales and Value Analysis & 5 Year Revaluation Report	
2024 BOA Tax Classification	GIS Online Map		Senior Citizen Property Tax Work Off Program	
Report: Municipal Finance Services Related to FY 2023 Valuations	Residential Property Questionnaire			
Tax Rate Investigation of 2023 for 2022				



New Assessor Team

Assembled this Past Year

Lynda McQuade

Lunenburg Principal Assessor

Denise McCue

Data Collector

Robin Nano

Admin Assessing Asst

Rena Sweezy

Contracted Part Time Assessor

Please Check Your Property Cards for Accuracy!!!

(Total of 5,266 parcels in town)

II. Update from Beacon Hill: State Representative

Representative
★ MARGARET R. SCARSDALE
Democrat - 1st Middlesex



✉ Margaret.Scarsdale@mahouse.gov

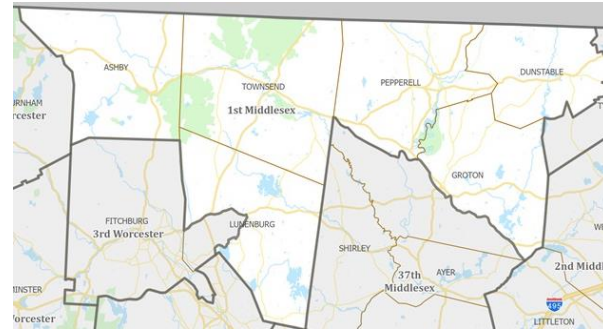


STATE HOUSE

24 Beacon St. 
Room 130
Boston, MA, 02133

Phone: (617) 722-2130

Precincts A, B1, C, and D, of the town of Lunenburg,



- [Joint Committee on Advanced Information Technology, the Internet and Cybersecurity](#)
- [Joint Committee on Community Development and Small Businesses](#)
- [Joint Committee on Emergency Preparedness and Management](#)
- [Joint Committee on Municipalities and Regional Government](#)

Topics

- + Means-tested Senior Tax Exemption
- + Nashoba Valley Medical Center
- + School Funding Formula
- + Muni Choice Bill
- + Modernize Cable Access



Lunenburg: H.3911 Senior Means Testing Property Tax Bill Has just been Signed By Governor!

Big Thank You to!

**Margaret Scarsdale (lead)
Mike Kushmerek
John Cronin**

III. Lunenburg Senior Housing Update:

Lunenburg Select Board: Vice Chairman

Michael Ray Jeffreys

Chairman of Lunenburg Municipal Design Committee

Sr. VP. of Asset Management



ADU's

Accessory Dwelling Units

Section 8 of Chapter 150 of the Acts of 2024 allows Accessory Dwelling Units (ADUs) (<900 SF) to be built by-right in single-family zoning districts.

Massachusetts has a new tool available to help meet our growing housing needs. Governor Healey and Lieutenant Governor Driscoll are committed to jumpstarting housing production and making it easier for families to find affordable places to live. Thanks to legislation signed by Governor Healey, single-family property owners now have the option to add a new rental apartment in their home or on their property.



55+ Community Housing Progress



Municipal Design Committee Progress



IV. Lunenburg Property Tax Exemptions-Updates and Notable Benchmarks.

Lead Assessor- Lynda McQuade

FY2025 Lunenburg Real Estate Tax Exemptions



What is a Real Estate Tax Exemption?

Creates a reduction in real estate taxes each year.
Each type of exemption has different qualifications.
Each type of exemption has a different application

What is required to apply for an Exemption?

To receive an exemption, you must apply every year.
Applicant may be required to provide the following:

- ✓ Birth Certificates
- ✓ Evidence of Domicile & Occupancy
- ✓ Income Tax Returns & Bank Statements
- ✓ If property in Trust, submit full trust documents

Deadlines

Deadline to File an Application is April 1, 2025.

ELDERLY	VETERANS		SURVIVING SPOUSE & MINOR	BLIND
CLAUSE 41D	CLAUSE 22	CLAUSE 22D	CLAUSE 17E & 17F	CLAUSE 37A
✓ Exemption Amount: \$1,000 ✓ Age: Must be 65 as of July 1. ✓ INCOME LIMIT: Single:\$24,000 Married:\$30,000 ✓ ASSET LIMIT: Single:\$40,000 Married:\$55,000 ✓ Must Own/Occupy Property For 5 Years. ✓ Lived in MA for 10 Years.	✓ Exemption Amount: \$400 ✓ Certification of a service connected disability or death from the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs or Branch of U.S. military service from which discharged. ✓ Must Provide Evidence of Residency, Ownership, Domicile and Occupancy.	✓ Exemption Amount: Full ✓ Surviving Spouses (who have never remarried) of Military personnel who on or after September 11, 2001, 1) were killed or went missing in action and are killed in combat or 2) died as a result of injuries sustained or diseases contracted in combat. ✓ Must have lived in MA for 5 consecutive yrs. or soldier had been domiciled in MA for at least 6 mos. before end of service.	✓ Exemption Amount: \$185 ✓ Surviving Spouse or Persons Over 70 who do not Qualify For 41D. ✓ ASSET LIMIT: \$40,000 ✓ 17E allows the Asset Limit to increase per COLA as of July 1, 2025. ✓ 17F allows the Exemption Amount to increase per COLA as of July 1, 2025. ✓ Must Have Lived in MA for Preceding 10 Years and Owned Property for 5 Years.	✓ Exemption Amount: \$500 ✓ Must submit a Certificate of Legal Blindness from the MA. Commis. for the Blind
**41D AND 17E & F WILL HAVE THE YEARLY COLA (COST OF LIVING ADJUSTMENT) FOR FY2026 (as of July 1, 2025). Assets include checking/savings account, stocks, bonds, 401K's, IRA's, recreational vehicles, 2nd homes, etc.				
FOR MORE INFORMATION, PLEASE CONTACT THE ASSESSORS OFFICE AT 978-582-4145 Lynda McQuade, Principal Assessor - lmquade@lunenburgma.gov Robin Nano, Administrative Assessing Assistant - mano@lunenburgma.gov				

Veterans



V. Game Changers:

A. Senior Circuit Breaker



& 41A Deferral Clause



... BOA - John Rabbitt

B. H3911: Lunenburg Senior Tax Relief Bill ...Authors : Speaker- Former Select BD & BOA - L Franco
Select Bd - T Alonzo

Two Separate Programs that can work Together

A.

Senior Circuit Breaker

Home Owners & Renters



Mass Personal Income Tax Reduction (Max Refund \$2,730)

You Get A Check....Not a Credit!!

C.

H.3911 Means-tested senior tax exemption for Lunenburg -New... Coming 2026

B.

41A Property Tax Deferral Clause

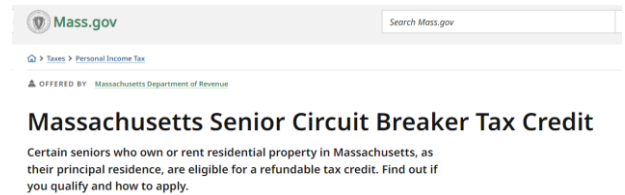
Applications Deadline April 1



CB- Application forms:

<https://www.mass.gov/doc/2024-schedule-cb-circuit-breaker-credit/download>

A. Senior Circuit Breaker



<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/massachusetts-senior-circuit-breaker-tax-credit>

Who is eligible

- You must be a Massachusetts resident or part-year resident.
- You must be 65 or older by December 31 of the tax year.
- You must file a [Schedule CB](#) with your Massachusetts personal income tax return.
- You must own or rent residential property in Massachusetts and occupy it as your primary residence.
- For tax year 2023, your total Massachusetts income doesn't exceed:
 - \$72,000 for a single individual who is not the head of a household.
 - \$91,000 for a head of household.
 - \$109,000 for married couples filing a joint return.
- If you are a homeowner, your Massachusetts property tax payments, together with half of your water and sewer expense, must exceed 10% of your Total Massachusetts Income for the tax year.
- If you are a renter, 25% of your annual Massachusetts rent must exceed 10% of your total Massachusetts income for the tax year.
- The assessed valuation of the homeowner's personal residence as of January 1, 2023, before residential exemptions but after abatements, cannot exceed \$1,172,000.
- The [Schedule CB](#) must be completed within 3 years from the last day for filing the return, without regard to any extension of time to file.

<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/massachusetts-senior-circuit-breaker-tax-credit#how-to-apply->

Circuit Breaker Video ... Politicians
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PN9U2FVR5FI>

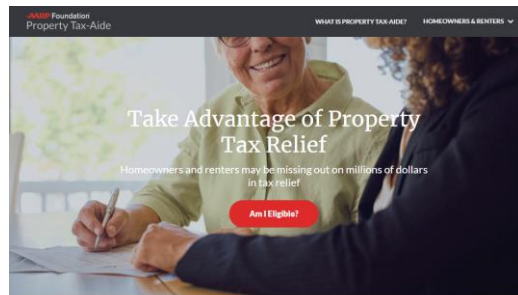
How to Verify Eligibility for Senior Circuit Breaker

Easily & Quickly!!!!



Visit the AARP Site – Its Free

<https://aarpfoundation.org/propertytaxaide>



Millions of Americans Can Save on Property Taxes –
Are You One of Them?

Did you know that over 9 million Americans are eligible for property tax relief but most aren't receiving it? This valuable assistance could put \$200 to \$6,000 back in your pocket, helping you afford essentials like housing, food, and medicine.

Schedule CB
Circuit Breaker Credit



<https://www.mass.gov/doc/2024-schedule-cb-circuit-breaker-credit/download>

Calculation Example

A.	All your Income	(See Full List)				<u>60,000</u>
B.	Credits	Realestate Taxes				5744
		1/2 Water & Sewer				500
		Total Credit				<u>6244</u>
	Income Threshold (10%)					10.40%
	B/A=%	6244	/	60,000	=	0.104067
						Qualified - Greater than 10%

Also: Full Overview of Circuit Breaker

<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/massachusetts-senior-circuit-breaker-tax-credit>

V. Game Changers:

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& 41A Deferral Clause



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B. 41A Property Tax Deferral Clause

Applications Deadline April 1



CB- Application forms:

<https://www.mass.gov/doc/2024-schedule-cb-circuit-breaker-credit/download>

B.

41A Property Tax Deferral Clause



Michael J. Heffernan
Commissioner of Revenue
Sean R. Conlin
Senior Deputy Commissioner

TAXPAYER'S GUIDE TO LOCAL PROPERTY TAX DEFERRALS

SENIORS Clause 41A

Under Clause 41A, seniors may also be able to delay payment of their property taxes. A property tax deferral does not discharge the tax obligation like an exemption. Instead, it defers payment until the senior sells the property or passes away. A deferral allows seniors to use resources that would go to pay taxes to defray living expenses instead. Taxpayers who qualify for personal exemptions under other clauses in M.G.L. c. 59, § 5 (for example, for seniors, disabled veterans, blind persons or surviving spouses) may defer all or part of the balance of their reduced taxes.

If you qualify, you must enter into a written tax deferral and recovery agreement with the local assessors. The assessors will record a statement at the Registry of Deeds

INCOME LIMITS Your income (gross receipts) for the previous calendar year cannot exceed \$20,000. If you are married, the combined gross receipts of you and your spouse cannot exceed \$20,000. The gross receipts limit may be increased up to the income limit allowed for the "circuit breaker" state income tax credit for single non-head of household filers, by vote of the legislative body of your city or town

Significant Updated For tax year 2024: Per the Circuit Breaker Guidelines, the taxpayer's "total income" cannot exceed \$72,000 for a single individual who is not the head of a household.

mass.gov/doc/qualifying-persons/download

B.

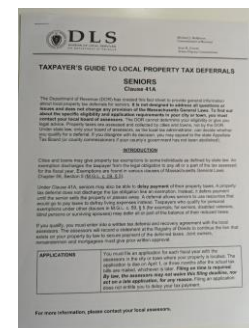
41A Property Tax Deferral Clause



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TAXPAYER'S GUIDE TO LOCAL PROPERTY TAX DEFERRALS

SENIORS Clause 41A



mass.gov/doc/qualifying-persons/download

DEFERRAL AMOUNT: You may defer payment of all or a part of the taxes owed each year so long as (1) you continue to qualify, and (2) the cumulative deferred taxes and accrued interest are not more than 50% of your proportional ownership

DEFERRAL AMOUNT INTEREST: Interest on deferred taxes accrues at ~~X~~%, or a lower rate voted by the legislative body of your city or town before July 1 of the tax year.

Now = 4% effective July 1 2006:Annual Town Meeting

SURVIVING SPOUSE: Your surviving spouse who qualifies may continue to defer taxes but must enter into a new deferral and recovery agreement.

PAYMENT: The payment of deferred taxes and accrued interest is due when the property is sold or you pass away, unless your surviving spouse continues to defer. As of that date, the interest rate goes up to 16%.

B.

41A Property Tax Deferral Clause



Assumptions for Deferral Evaluation

➤ If You Assume the following:

- + Today's Home Valuation of \$ 400K:
- + Your Current Lunenburg Home Sales Price will Increase 4% annually 
- + You and your spouse will eventually leave your home in 15 years. (Can be longer too!)
- + Your current property tax bill is \$5744 and will increase 3% annually
- + You are Qualified for the 41A Deferral program.
- + Numbers below assume no mortgage. If you have a Bank/Mortgage or Remainderman you will need to seek approval.

➤ Then

- + Your Current Annual Property \$5744 tax will be deferred (\$478 per month and increases to \$745.)
- + You can keep the cash in your family budget for Food, Heat, Gas, etc.... Your deferral approach will help keep up with the increasing inflation costs to your household,
- + The annual appreciation on your house will far exceed the deferral amount with interest charged.
- + When you go to sell your \$400K house (current value), you could sell it for \$720,37
- + After paying the town back \$145,149 (for deferred property taxes and interest); your net gain from your deferral program will be \$175,229.
- + Your total "Walk Away" gain would leave you approximately \$575,229.

= Conclusion: It's a "Winning Deal": You can stay in your home and still create cash. You won't have to downsize and give up your passions. You will know where the light switch is in the dark. And so much more!

See Spread sheet Details next slide= 18

41A Property Tax Deferral Clause



Deferral Calculations																
Rev D																
Home Value Growth	Today	Year End														Net Home Value Appreciation Over 15 Years
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Sales Price Growth at 4% Annually.	400,000	416000	432640	449,946	467,943	486,661	506,128	526,373	547,428	569,325	592,098	615,782	640,413	666,029	692,671	720,377
Annual Appreciation Growth		16,000	16,640	17,306	17,998	18,718	19,466	20,245	21,055	21,897	22,773	23,684	24,631	25,617	26,641	27,707
																320,377
Deferral																Total Deferred Property Taxes over 15 Years
EST Annual Property Tax growth at 3%	5744	5,916	6,094	6,277	6,465	6,659	6,859	7,064	7,276	7,495	7,719	7,951	8,190	8,435	8,688	8,949
Taxes Paid =		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	106,832
Interest Paid on Deferred Taxes at 4%																106,832
Year 1		230														
Year 2		239	237													
Year 3		249	246	244												
Year 4		258	256	254	251											
Year 5		269	266	264	261	259										
Year 6		280	277	274	272	269	266									
Year 7		291	288	285	282	280	277	274								
Year 8		302	299	297	294	291	288	285	283							
Year 9		314	311	308	305	303	300	297	294	291						
Year 10		327	324	321	318	315	312	309	306	303	300					
Year 11		340	337	334	330	327	324	321	318	315	312	309				
Year 12		354	350	347	344	340	337	334	331	327	324	321	318			
Year 13		368	364	361	357	354	351	347	344	340	337	334	331	328		
Year 14		383	379	375	372	368	365	361	358	354	351	347	344	341	337	
Year 15		398	394	390	387	383	379	375	372	368	365	361	358	354	351	348
																Total Deferred Interest to be paid at end of occupancy
Total Interest Charged		4601	4329	4053	3772	3488	3198	2903	2604	2299	1988	1672	1351	1023	688	348
Total Interest Paid	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	38,316
Gross Gain in home value by occupying home for 15 additional years.	320,377															
	Sum Of Past 15 years of actaul deferred taxes	106,832														
	4% Interest Charges on Actaul Deferred Amount	38,316														
	Total to be paid to Lunenburg at end of 15 years	145,149														
Net Gain from Deferral	175,229															
Home Owner will walk away from Home with	575,229	Plus ability to stay in the house for 15 years, with extra monthly spending money of total \$106,832 (average \$593), and No Fear of Losing Home to Property Taxes														



41A Property Tax Deferral Clause

Question 1 = What will be the financial impact to our town?

Answer: Believe it to be Neutral on Town Balance sheet.. Your will be exchanging a full value lien with interest; agreed by the town.

- + Town will hold the Property Liens for full taxed amount, plus interest (4%).
- + Will allow Seniors to stay in their homes longer, & promotes Senior feeling of well being.
- + Will influence the inflow of “School Age” children & expenses, as a result of keeping seniors in their homes.
- + Note: that Town’s Cash flow will be affected; Can be offset with a reduction of Free Cash and or the Stabilization Account.

Question 2 = What if I have a mortgage, or a joint owner, or a remaindermen?

Answer: Your Bank/Mortgage company, joint owner or remainder must provide written approval. They will be asked to take a second position, to Towns Deferral Lien. Some Banks will accept a second position and others may not. Ask your bank.

More Help???

**Contact the Board of Assessors to
Learn More about All the Property
Clauses & Exemptions and your
Property Taxes....**

OR

**Contact the Lunenburg Adult Activity
Center: Outreach Coordinator:
Pauline Roy for Assistance with the
Circuit Breaker & The 41A Deferral.**

VI. Game Changers:

B. H3911: Lunenburg Senior Tax Relief Bill ...Authors :

Author & Speaker: Former Select BD & BOA - L Franco

Author & Select Bd Member - T Alonzo

Article 21- Home Rule Petition for Senior Tax Relief Program

I move to amend Article 21 by striking the word "residential" in the second sentence of SECTION 3.

The amended sentence would read as: "The total amount exempted by this act shall be allocated proportionally within the tax levy on all taxpayers and shall not exceed 1 percent of the town-wide real property tax levy."

Article 21 – Senior Tax Relief

How it works -- in essence, it is a Community Care Act

1. This act is revenue neutral to the Town of Lunenburg. Its enactment will not positively nor negatively impact the tax levy calculations or collection.
2. The total amount of exemptions provided pursuant to this act will be shifted to all non-exempt real properties in the Town of Lunenburg.
3. A "yes" vote authorizes the Select Board to petition the Legislature for special legislation which will take between 12-24 months.
4. Once enabled, it may be revoked by a majority vote of any subsequent Annual or Special Town Meeting.

Article 21 – Senior Tax Relief

Applicant Qualifications

1. Applicant(s) must have applied for and been granted the State's Senior Circuit Breaker Tax Credit.
2. Each Applicant at or over 70 years old must have applied for and been granted the elderly exemption in Lunenburg under MGL Ch59 Sec.5 41(C).
3. Each Applicant in the application must be 65+ years old.
4. The Applicant(s) must have owned and occupied a home in the Town of Lunenburg as his/her/their primary residence for at least 15 consecutive years including the date of the application.

COMING SOON
UNDER CONSTRUCTION

Article 21 – Senior Tax Relief

Applicant Qualifications (continued)

5. The Applicant has demonstrated to the satisfaction of the Lunenburg Board of Assessors that (s)he, and each co-Applicant, owns no other significant assets such as, by way of nonlimiting example, a second home, a trust fund, securities, equities and bonds.

The Applicant(s) must apply annually.

State Approved and Details Under Construction by BOA

H.3911 Means-tested senior tax exemption for Lunenburg : **Process to Be Resolved**

SECTION 1. With respect to each qualifying parcel of real property classified as class one, residential in the town of Lunenburg, there shall be an exemption from the property tax in an amount to be set annually by the board of assessors as provided in section 3. The exemption shall be applied to the domicile of the taxpayer only. For the purposes of this act, "parcel" shall mean a unit of real property as defined by the board of assessors under the deed for the property and shall include a condominium unit. The exemption provided for herein shall be in addition to any other exemptions allowed under the General Laws.

SECTION 2. The board of assessors of the town of Lunenburg may deny an application for exemption if the board finds that an applicant has excessive assets that place the applicant outside of the intended recipients of the senior citizen tax exemption created by this act. Real property shall qualify for the exemption under section 1 if all of the following criteria are met:

- (i) The qualifying real property is owned and occupied by an Applicant who has applied for **and been granted the State's Senior Circuit Breaker Tax Credit**;
- (ii) Each Applicant named in an application who has attained the eligibility age of 70 years for an elderly exemption in Lunenburg under M.G.L. Chapter 59, Section 5, Clause 41(C) must have applied for and been granted this exemption;
- (iii) Each Applicant named in an application has attained the age of 65 years by the close of the calendar year immediately preceding the year of application;
- (iv) The Applicant has owned and occupied a home in the Town of Lunenburg, as his or her primary residence, for at least 15 consecutive years pre-dating and including the date of application;
- (v) The Applicant has demonstrated to the satisfaction of the Lunenburg Board of Assessors that (s)he, and each co-applicant, owns no other significant assets such as, by way of nonlimiting example, a second home, a trust fund, securities, equities, and bonds.
- (vi) The amount of relief granted to each Applicant under this program shall not exceed 100 percent of the Circuit Breaker Tax Credit for which the Applicant qualified in the previous year.

SECTION 3. The board of assessors of the town of Lunenburg shall annually set the exemption amount provided for in section 1 relative; provided, however, that the amount of the exemption shall not exceed the amount of the circuit breaker income tax credit pursuant to subsection (k) of section 6 of chapter 62 of the General Laws for which the applicant qualified in the previous year. The total amount exempted by this act shall be allocated proportionally within the tax levy on all taxpayers and shall not exceed 1 percent of the town-wide real property tax levy. **To the extent that the total value of exemption requests timely received by the board of assessors exceeds 1 percent of the levy, the exemption amount for which each applicant has otherwise established eligibility shall be proportionally reduced by multiplying the established eligibility amount by a quotient equal to 1 percent of the levy divided by the total town-wide dollar value of exemption requests for which Applicants in the aggregate would be eligible in the absence of the cap represented by 1 percent of the levy.**

SECTION 4. A person who seeks to qualify for the exemption under section 1 shall, before the deadline established by the board of assessors of the town of Lunenburg, file an application, on a form to be adopted by the board of assessors, with the supporting documentation of the applicant's income and assets as described in the application. An applicant must submit an application, and demonstrate eligibility, for each year for which the applicant seeks the exemption.

SECTION 5. No exemption shall be granted under this act until the department of revenue certifies a residential tax rate for the applicable tax year where the total exemption amount is raised by a burden shift within the residential tax levy.

SECTION 6. This act may be revoked by an affirmative vote of a majority of town meeting voters at any annual or special town meeting. Any such revocation shall take effect 30 days after an affirmative vote of town meeting.

VI Senior Tax Work Off Program & Volunteers ... Select Person Chair – Caesar Nuzzolo



The Town of Lunenburg will offer income eligible senior citizens age 60+ an opportunity to receive up to \$1500 off their property tax bill.

Participants work in various Town Departments to earn the tax abatement.

Between January 1, 2025 and November 1, 2024 a person will receive \$15.00 per hour, up to 100 hours, to receive the \$1500 abatement. Any hours worked beyond that will be considered volunteer hours.

Application package can be picked up at:
Eagle House
Lunenburg Adult Activity Center
25 Memorial Drive
Lunenburg, MA 01462

OR

Town Hall
17 Main Street
Lunenburg, MA 01462





Are you eligible?

- Must be 60 years of age or older at time of application
- Own or occupy a home in Lunenburg as your primary residence for at least one year
- Applications must provide verification of useable gross income in order to be considered (prior year 1040 income tax return required)
- Receive a property tax bill in your name or spouse's name who is also 60 years of age or older
- Meet the income guidelines of
 - One person household- \$50,000*
 - Two person household- \$75,000*

6.17 Exemption Related to Senior Tax Abatement Programs

1.) Purpose: The purpose of 930 CMR 6.17 is to allow participants in senior tax abatement programs to hold additional municipal positions and have financial interests in municipal contracts, and vice versa.

2.) Exemption: A participant in a senior tax abatement program may hold additional municipal positions and have financial interests in municipal contracts without violating M.G.L. c.268A §20, provided that the employee does not participate in or have official responsibility for the administration of such program or decision making with respect to the award of benefits or relief under such program.



All new applicants will require a CORI background check.

Earnings are exempt from state taxes only. Earnings are subject to federal and Medicare tax withholdings and are also subject to OBRA if participant is not receiving a pension from either Worcester Regional Retirement or Massachusetts State Teachers Retirement.

All necessary paperwork must be completed before any work is done.

All applicants must apply and be accepted annually for participation in the program.



Senior Tax Work-Off Program

Contact:
Julie Belliveau
Assistant Town Manager/HR Director
Phone: 978-582-4130 x150
E-mail: jbelliveau@lunenburgma.gov

Senior Tax Work-Off Program

Max: \$75K Couples Income
\$1500 from program

Hourly: \$15.00 Hr.
Mass Tax Exempt

Applied to your property Taxes

VI Senior Tax Work Off Program & **Volunteers** ... Select Person Chair – Caesar Nuzzolo



All elected and appointed boards in town are fully composed of volunteers. Protecting our beautiful community on the Conservation Commission or digging into town finances on the Finance Committee there are so many ways you can participate in local government join a community of caring and dedicated volunteers and make our town a better place to live!



**TOWN OF LUNENBURG
OFFICE OF THE SELECT BOARD**

VOLUNTEER TO SERVE YOUR TOWN

Please take a look at the open vacancies on our various Boards:

- Board of Health
- Cultural Council
- Finance Committee
- Personnel Committee
- Historical Commission
- Stormwater Task Force
- Agricultural Commission
- Zoning Board of Appeals
- Library Board of Trustees
- Conservation Commission
- Green Communities Committee
- Master Plan Steering Committee
- Public Access Cable Committee (PACC)
- Architectural Preservation District Commission

TO APPLY

Click the "Careers/Volunteer" icon on the front page of the Town website
lunenburgma.gov/volunteer OR scan the QR code below:



SCAN WITH
YOUR PHONE'S
CAMERA!

If any openings look like a good fit to you, please consider getting involved!

Q & A



“How Can We Help You?” Seniors Conference II

Date Feb 3 2025 1- 3PM

Did you find this conference helpful?

Yes

No

Would you like more information on:

I. Lunenburg’s Changing Senior Imperative... COA - Deb Lincoln (Chairman)
... BOA - John Rabbitt

Yes

No

II. Updates from Beacon Hill: State Representative - Margaret Scarsdale

Yes

No

III. Lunenburg Senior Housing Update: ... Select Bd. Vice Chairman – Michael-Ray Jeffreys

Yes

No

IV. Property Tax Exemptions & Changes ... Principal Assessor- Lynda McQuade

Yes

No

V. Game Changers:

A. Senior Circuit Breaker & 41A Deferral Clause ... BOA - John Rabbitt

Yes

No

B. Lunenburg Senior Tax Relief Bill... Select Bd. Authors - Tom Alonzo & Lou Franco

Yes

No

VI. Senior Tax Work Off Program & Volunteers ... Select Board Chairman – Caesar Nuzzolo

Yes

No

Comments?
.....

If Yes on information: Name _____

Email _____

